

Epilogue The Eternal Spirit of Genghis Khan Is it our fault we have forgotten our history?

D. JARGALSAIKHAN GENGHIS KHAN'S WAS THE last great tribal empire of world history. He was the heir of ten thousand years of war between the nomadic tribes and the civilized world, the ancient struggle of the hunter and herder against the farmer. It was a history as old as the story of the Bedouin tribes that followed Muhammad to smash the pagan idolatry of the city, of the Roman campaigns against the Huns, of the Greeks against the wandering Scythians, of the city dwellers of Egypt and Persia who preyed on the wandering tribes of Hebrew herders, and, ultimately, of Cain, the tiller, who slew his brother Abel, the herder. The clash between the nomadic and urban cultures did not end with Genghis Khan, but it would never again reach the level to which he brought it. Civilization pushed the tribal people toward the ever more distant edges of the world. Chiefs such as Sitting Bull and Crazy Horse of the Lakota Sioux, Red Eagle of the Muskogee, Tecumseh of the Shawnee, and Shaka Zulu of South Africa valiantly but vainly continued the quest of Genghis Khan over the coming centuries. Without knowing anything about the Mongols or Genghis Khan, these other chiefs faced the same struggles and fought the same battles across Africa and throughout the Americas, but history had moved beyond them. In the end, sedentary civilization won the long world war; the future belonged to the civilized children of Cain, who eternally encroached upon the open lands of the tribes. Although he arose out of the ancient tribal past, Genghis Khan shaped the modern world of commerce, communication, and large secular states more than any other individual. He was the thoroughly modern man in his mobilized and professional warfare and in his commitment to global commerce and the rule of international secular law. What began as a war of extinction between the nomad and the farmer ended as a Mongol amalgamation of cultures. His vision matured as he aged and as he experienced different ways of life. He worked to create something new and better for his people. The Mongol armies destroyed the uniqueness of the civilizations around them by shattering the protective walls that isolated one civilization from another and by knotting the cultures together. The great actors of history cannot be neatly tucked between the covers of a book and filed away like so many pressed botanical specimens. Their actions cannot be explained according to a specific timetable like the coming and going of so many trains. Although scholars may designate the beginning and ending of an era with exact precision, great historical events, particularly those that erupt suddenly and violently, build up slowly, and, once having begun, never end. Their effects linger long after the action faded from view. Like the tingling vibrations of a bell that we can still sense well after it has stopped ringing, Genghis Khan has long passed from the scene, but his influence continues to reverberate through our time. In April 2000, I followed the trail that Temujin and his family probably took eight centuries earlier when they fled from the attacking Merkid who had come to kidnap Borte. After locating the likely spot of the attack on Temujin's camp, the direction from which the Merkid came, and the path by which the group fled, we set off to follow the chase from the steppe to the mountains. The local herding boys

were themselves about the same age as the ones whose trail we were now retracing. They were just as skilled with horses as their ancient predecessors, and they wore the traditional Mongol deel with a tightly wrapped sash of bright gold silk just below the waist. Except for the occasional baseball cap, sunglasses, or jeans worn under the deel, their clothes were still the same heavy layers of wool, fleece, and felt garments worn by their ancestors. Our nine horses, like those of Hoelun's fleeing family, were geldings, and the descriptions of the horses in the Secret History are so precise that we could have matched them up by age, color, shape, and other characteristics. Instead, we simply rode with the horses that an old and slightly drunk herder had designated as most appropriate for our task. We did not need to search for the route so much as merely follow the guidance and intuition of the nomads. They knew precisely how a horse and rider would get from here to there. They knew where the ice was too thin to cross the river, where the snow was too deep in the small depressions, and where a cluster of marmot burrows might trip one of the racing horses. The wind made the new snow dance around the horse's hooves as we slowly climbed the rocky slope of Burkhan Khaldun, the most sacred mountain in Mongolia. The horse nervously snorted moist puffs of steam into the crisp air. His head jerked. Under the strain of a long, hard climb in such a thin altitude, his heart pounded so loudly that I heard it above the rushing wind, and I felt it throbbing up through my legs to my heart. When we paused in the bright crystal clear light, we saw all the way to the horizon in all directions—across the mountain peaks, boulder fields, winding rivers, and frozen lakes. When he had finished his work, Genghis Khan returned here, as he always had after each victory, for rest, recovery, and renewal. He had changed the world but had allowed nothing to change in the land of his birth. Today, hawks soar overhead in spring, and the insects still sing in summer just as they did in his day. Nomads move to the hills in autumn, and wolves prowl in winter. When I close my eyes, I can still hear the distant thunder of his horse's hooves as they gallop off to China, Europe, and India. Leaving the forested mountains and riding back to find our Jeeps, we decided to return to where the story and our expedition began, the place where the Merkid kidnapped Borte from Temujin. The steppe stretched to the horizon in every direction, barren of trees and unmarred by buildings, roads, fences, electric lines, or other scars of the modern world. During my repeated visits, I had learned to mark the land as the Mongols do, by color of season. The brief green summer lured the mating birds; the yellow fall enticed the horses to race and goats to gnaw at the drying plants. The white winter would find camels wandering slowly up and down the frozen river searching for patches of dried grass, and the brown spring provided only a time of waiting for new grass by the animals and the humans who live off them. Isolated, remote, and unchanged by the centuries, this locale marks the place where Temujin became a man and changed the Mongols from a tribe into a nation. Upon our return to the windy place where we thought the abduction had occurred, our group grew quiet in the bitter wind that whipped around us. We had fulfilled the mission, and we returned to the spot with a new sense of amazement at

what had happened here. The outline of many old campsites were clearly marked by large stones that once were used to tie down the ger in the fierce winds. The Mongol camps now lay cold and empty. Yet it seemed that if I only kicked the dust, I would feel the warmth of the smoldering ashes rising from his last campfire. If I brushed away the snow, I would see the prints of his horses in the frozen mud. The stones seem to have been left quite casually, as though at any time now the owner might return, dust them off, and once again erect either a winter camp for his yaks and sheep or an imperial capital of the world—whichever is most needed at the moment. We stood in a silent cluster in the whistling wind, tightened our jackets, pulled down our hats, and stared at the ground. One by one, members of the group walked away to gather a few stones and piled them on the spot, in the way that nomadic people have marked important places for thousands of years. The senior horseman, a local headman, gathered some of the dried horse dung, piled it in front of the stones, and, as others blocked the wind by spreading open their flowing deels, lit the dung in much the same way that a mother kindles the fire before the family erects their ger around it. Once the dung ignited, Professor O. Sukhbaatar sprinkled some incense of finely ground cedar into the fire. The smell generated a soothing effect that softened the excitement of the long search, and at the same time focused our attention on the fire itself. The smoke wafting from the incense and dung signaled the success and conclusion of this phase in our quest. All the men shuffled a little and gradually pulled themselves up more erectly. Every culture has its proper way to dress and appear respectful. For the Mongols, the three breast buttons had to be securely fastened, their collars pulled straight, and the sleeves of the deels pulled down to cover their wrists and part of the upper hand. Each man tightened the wide gold sash and then bloused out the upper part of the deel to make it loose and full. When we had identified the place on our earlier passage through here, the herders had asked Professor Sukhbaatar to mark a stone on this place so that everyone would know what had happened. A lady who lived nearby explained that because such knowledge was forbidden for so long, they wanted their children to know it now. For them, the way to remember it was to have it carved in stone. All of the herders respected the elderly professor. They knew him from the years after the purge of scholars, when alone and at great risk to his life, he set out on his journey of more than a million kilometers tracing the route of Genghis Khan and relying on the hospitality of the herders to protect, house, and feed him in his quest. Now, after completing our journey, Professor Sukhbaatar consented to their request to erect a stone to commemorate the kidnapping of Borte from Temujin. It was quickly decided that he would write the text, Professor T. Jamyansuren would design the calligraphy of the Old Mongol script, and the students would find a stone and engrave it. After sending a student to fetch his well-worn almanac, Professor Sukhbaatar squinted through his smudged glasses to follow a long series of charts and diagrams. He made notes with a stubby pencil on a small slip of paper, performed some quick calculations, and looked up more charts in the almanac. He then announced the most propitious day on which the students should

return to this spot to erect the stone. This piece of business behind us, Professor Lkhagvasuren pulled a bottle of vodka out from the hidden recess of his deel, sprinkled it on the stones, threw some into the air, and touched it to his forehead. In some intimate way or other, each person connected directly back to the story we were researching. Lkhagvasuren had traveled this area many times with his teacher and mentor, the archaeologist Perlee, and when the authorities put Perlee in prison, they also arrested Lkhagvasuren's father for being too much of a nationalist. They sent his stepmother into internal exile far out in the country, and as the children of political prisoners Lkhagvasuren and his younger siblings were turned out into the streets of Ulaanbaatar. In the months before the authorities came to take him away to the Children's Prison, he managed to heap enough dirt over a small shed outside of town to serve as a home for his siblings through the winter while they would be alone. After spending his teen years in prison and in forced service on a distant border, he resumed the archaeological work of his mentor. For each person—whether herder or scholar—the history around us was neither abstract nor distant; their Mongol history cut through their lives as sharply as if the events had happened only last week. For me, the quest across Mongolia and back through time had begun in nearly childlike curiosity that had developed into an intellectual and scholarly quest, but for my Mongol colleagues each step in our search grew much more personal and much more deeply emotional. Each day, as we understood better the hardships and heroism of their ancestors, we slipped farther back into time. Where we stood was not just another historical place; on this spot, the mother of the Mongol nation had been attacked, kidnapped, and ravished. When she was taken from him, the boy Temujin risked all, including his young life, to get her back. He rescued her, and for the rest of his life he fought to keep his own people safe from outside attack, even though that meant that he would spend his life attacking outsiders. In the process, he changed the world, and he created a nation. They knelt before the small pile of smoking dung, sniffing and with tears pooling in the corners of their eyes. In the golden but dimming light of dusk, eight centuries melted away, and the pain of that dawn of terror so long ago floated in the smoke around us. As the incense burned on the small mound of stones, each person stepped forward individually to honor this place. He took off his hat, knelt before the stones, touched his head to the frozen earth of this sacred spot, and then got up and walked slowly three times around the stones while tossing vodka into the air. Each person pulled out something as a small personal gift to leave on the stones—the stub of a sugar cube, a few matches, a candy wrapped in crinkling paper, a sprinkle of tea leaves. It was almost as though they wanted to reach back through the centuries to offer these small gifts of nourishment and warmth to the fleeing and frightened Borte as her kidnappers slung her on a horse and galloped away with her to an unknown future. It was as though the members of our muted group wanted to tell her, their mother, that everything would be all right, that she and they, her children, would survive it all for eight more centuries. After all, they are still the children of the Golden Light, the offspring of a wolf and a doe, and in the wispy

clouds of the Eternal Blue Sky of Mongolia, the Spirit Banner of Genghis Khan still waves in the wind. Notes These notes are to help the reader find information from a variety of sources. Works are cited in languages other than English only if no English translation could be identified. Introduction: The Missing Conqueror “Genghis Khan was a doer”: Joel Aschenbacher, “The Era of His Ways: In Which We Chose the Most Important Man of the Last Thousand Years,” *Washington Post*, December 31, 1989, p. F01. unprecedented rise in cultural communication: For more information on the cultural exchange, see Thomas T. Allsen, *Culture and Conquest in Mongol Eurasia* (Cambridge, U.K.: Cambridge University Press, 2001). Roger Bacon observed: The quotes are from Bacon’s *Opus Majus*, trans. Robert Belle Burke (Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press, 1928), vol. 1, p. 416; vol. 2. p. 792. “we imagined your appearance”: From “Chinggis Khaan,” composed by D. Jargalsaikhan and performed by the musical group Chinggis Khaan. Rashid al-Din described: The quotes are from Allsen, *Culture and Conquest in Mongol Eurasia*, p. 88. Arab politicians: Quoted in Eric L. Jones, *Growth Recurring: Economic Change in World History* (Oxford, U.K.: Clarendon Press, 1988), p. 113. “tendencies directed at idealizing the role of Genghis Khan”: Almaz Khan, “Chinggis Khan: From Imperial Ancestor to Ethnic Hero,” in *Cultural Encounters on China’s Ethnic Frontiers*, ed. Stevan Harrell (Seattle: University of Washington Press, 1995), pp. 261–262. anti-party elements, Chinese spies, saboteurs, or pests: Tom Ginsburg, “Nationalism, Elites, and Mongolia’s Rapid Transformation,” in *Mongolia in the Twentieth Century: Landlocked Cosmopolitan*, ed. Stephen Kotkin and Bruce A. Elleman (Armonk, N.Y.: M. E. Sharpe, 1999), p. 247. I worked closely with: Most Mongolians today use a single name such as Lkhagvasuren or Sukhbaatar, but when necessary to distinguish among those with the same name, they identify themselves by the initial (or first two letters in the case of sh, ch, kh or ts) of a parent. I. The Reign of Terror on the Steppe: 1162–1206 “Nations! What are nations?”: Henry David Thoreau, *Journal* (Princeton, N.J.: Princeton University Press, 1981), entry for May 1, 1851. 1. The Blood Clot “There is fire in his eyes”: *Secret History*, § 62. “choked with horsemen”: Ata-Malik Juvaini, *Genghis Khan: The History of the World Conqueror*, trans. J. A. Boyle (Seattle: University of Washington Press, 1997), p. 98. “whoever yields”: *Ibid.*, p. 15. “a man of tall stature”: Minhaj al-Siraj Juzjani, *Tabakat-I-Nasiri: A General History of the Muhammadan Dynasties of Asia*, trans. Major H. G. Raverty (Bengal: Asiatic Society of Bengal, 1881; reprint, New Dehli: Oriental Books, 1970), p. 1077. “it is the great ones, among you”: *Ibid.* p. 105. “like a red-hot furnace”: Juvaini, p. 106. “If you but live”: *Secret History*, § 56. Targutai boasted: *Secret History*, § 149. early age of nine: The early events in Temujin’s life prove difficult to date precisely with confidence. The Mongols counted each new year as beginning at the end of winter when spring came. Each greening of the steppe counted as one new year, and age was counted according to the number of greenings a child had been through. Thus, the birth of Temujin at the start of spring gave him an immediate age of one, and each successive greening made him one year older. For purposes of this book, however, ages are calculated in the traditional

Western way. Yesugei's sons by his other wife: Regarding the marriage of a widow to a stepson, in one known case of an aristocratic Mongol family in the seventeenth century, after a woman's husband died, she married one of his sons; after that husband died, she then married his son. Finally, when this husband also died, she married his son. Thus, in her lifetime she was married to four men from the same family: her first husband, his son, his grandson, and his great-grandson. See J. Holmgren, "Observations on Marriage and Inheritance Practices in Early Mongol and Yüan Society, with Particular Reference to the Levirate," *Journal of Asian History* 20 (1986), p. 158. "of the skins of dogs and mice": Juvaini, *Genghis Khan*, p. 21. "food that could not be digested": *Secret History*, § 201. the eldest son assumed that role: The Mongol language reflects the importance of older siblings by having distinct words for older brother (akh) and older sister (egch), whereas younger siblings, both male and female, are lumped together in one term (dүү). The akh, "Elder Brother," had such importance that his title eventually became synonymous with the leader of a family cluster or other small group. In the case of full siblings, the ranking is obvious: by birth order. But for half siblings, the ranking order of the children depends on many factors, including, most particularly, the relative ranking of their mothers. "Destroyer! Destroyer!": *Secret History*, § 78. ten years in slavery: "Meng-Ta Peu-Lu Ausführliche Aufzeichnungen über die Mongolischen Tatan von Chao Hung, 1221," In Peter Olbricht and Elisabeth Pinks, *Meng-Ta Pei-Lu und Hei-Ta Shih Lüeh: Chinesische Gesandtenberichte über die frühen Mongolen 1221 und 1237* (Weisbaden: Otto Harrassowitz, 1980), p. 12. 2. Tale of Three Rivers "The banner of Chingiz-Khan's fortune": Ata-Malik Juvaini, *Genghis Khan: The History of the World Conqueror*, trans. J. A. Boyle (Seattle: University of Washington Press, 1997), p. 22. supernatural power: The etymology of many Mongol and Turkic words show a constant intertwining of physical and political prowess with supernatural strength. Khan, Mongolian for chief, is almost identical to the Turkic term for shaman, kham. The Mongolian female shaman was called an idu khan, while the term for male shaman originated in the same word for wrestler or athlete. "We have made their breasts to become empty:" Francis Woodman Cleaves, trans., *The Secret History of the Mongols* (Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press, 1982), par. 113, pp. 47–48. "let us love one another": Urgunge Onon, trans., *The History and the Life of Chinggis Khan (The Secret History of the Mongols)*, (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1990), § 117. Jamuka and Temujin rode together: For a contrasting interpretation of the class relations between the two men, see Boris Y. Vladimirtsov, *The Life of Chingis-Khan*, trans. Prince D. S. Mirsky (New York: Benjamin Blom, 1930). "Barren Island": Rachewiltz's translation of *The Secret History*, § 136, 1972. never forgot how Jelme saved him: Temujin's wound closely paralleled the nearly simultaneous battle wound suffered by King Richard the Lionhearted of England. In April 1199, while combating one of his rebel vassals, an arrow pierced his left shoulder. Richard tried to pull out the arrow, but its iron barb held and the shaft broke. For the next agonizing days, doctors treated him but without being able to combat the growing infection and fever. Finally, on the eleventh day, he died. His body was

embalmed but disassembled to be buried with great ostentation in different places of sentimental importance to him. His brain was removed and sent for burial in an abbey in Poitiers. His heart went to the cathedral in Rouen, and his body to the Abbey Fonteurault. In marked contrast, by sucking the blood from Temujin's wound, Jelme prevented him from following the painful and untimely fate of King Richard. He organized his warriors: For more information on troop estimates, see Bat-Ochir Bold, *Mongolian Nomadic Society: A Reconstruction of the "Medieval" History of Mongolia* (New York: St. Martin's Press, 2001), p. 85. "Let no one set up camp": *Secret History*, § 179. People of the Felt Walls: This phrase is still used in Mongolia, "Esgii Tuurgatan." 3. War of the Khans "All the tribes were of one color": Ata-Malik Juvaini, *Genghis Khan: The History of the World Conqueror*, trans. J. A. Boyle (Seattle: University of Washington Press), p. 38. "Is not Genghis Khan ashamed": Marco Polo, *The Travels of Marco Polo*, trans. Ronald Latham (London: Penguin Books, 1958), p. 94. Lake Baljuna: Baljuna is called a lake in the text, but it may have been a river or a small lake connected to the Balj River, a tributary of the Onon. The exact timing of the event is in great debate. Some scholars believe that it occurred at another point in the long civil wars and not as part of the betrayal by Ong Khan. A few scholars discount the story entirely, but based particularly on heavy Chinese documentation, most scholars accept it. For a full discussion of the event and the various versions of it, see Francis Woodman Cleaves, "The Historicity of the Baljuna Covenant," *Harvard Journal of Asiatic Studies* 18, nos. 3–4 (December 1955), pp. 357–421. "more fires than the stars in the sky": *Secret History*, § 194. "If he sends me into fire": "Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh Kurzer Bericht über die schwarzen Tatan von P'eng Ta-Ya und Sü T'ing, 1237," in Peter Olbricht and Elisabeth Pinks, *Meng-Ta Pei-Lu und Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh: Chinesische Gesandtenberichte über die frühen Mongolen 1221 und 1237* (Weisbaden: Otto Harrassowitz, 1980), p. 161. "rotten logs": *Secret History*, § 96. "Let us be companions": Urgunge Onon, trans., *The History and the Life of Chinggis Khan (The Secret History of the Mongols)* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1990), § 200. the headwaters of the Onon River: Regarding the location of the khuriltai of 1206, the *Secret History* describes the place as simply the headwaters of the Onon, but the seventeenth-century Erdeni-yin Tobchi places it more precisely on the island of Kherlen River. Paul Kahn, *The Secret History of the Mongols: The Origins of Chingis Khan*, exp. ed. (Boston: Cheng & Tsui, 1998), p. 189. "placed him upon a black Felt Carpet": François Pétis de la Croix, *The History of Genghizcan the Great: First Emperor of the Ancient Moguls and Tartars* (London: Printed for J. Darby, etc., 1722), pp. 62–63. "obstinate and has a petty, narrow mind": *Secret History*, § 243. The Great Law of Genghis Khan: For more information on the law of Genghis Khan, see Valentin A. Riasanovsky, *Fundamental Principles of Mongol Law, Uralic and Altaic Series*, vol. 43 (Bloomington: Indiana University Publications, 1965), p. 33. haggling over the value of a wife: For more information on marriage, see Paul Ratchnevsky, *Genghis Khan: His Life and Legacy*, trans. Thomas Nivison Haining. Oxford, U.K.: Blackwell, 1991), pp. 191. Theft of animals: For more information, see *ibid.*, p. 155. hunting rights for wild animals:

See Secret History, § 199. tax exemptions: For more information on Genghis Khan's tax law, see Riasanovsky, *Fundamental Principles of Mongol Law*, p. 83. the supremacy of the rule of law: For more information on the application of law to the royal family, See Boris Y. Vladimirtsov, *The Life of Chingis-Khan*, trans. Prince D. S. Mirsky (New York: Benjamin Blom, 1930), p. 74. "punish the thieves": Onon, Secret History, § 203. a system of fast riders: For a discussion of postal stations, see Bat-Ochir Bold, *Mongolian Nomadic Society: A Reconstruction of the "Medieval" History of Mongolia* (New York: St. Martin's Press, 2001), p. 168. Genghis Khan's shaman: Teb Tengeri's name was Kokochu. In the Secret History, four men had this name, and the text is not always clear on which is meant as the trustee of Hoelun's estate. Two Kokochus were already dead before this episode. In addition to the shaman, Kokochu was the name of the Tayichiud boy adopted by Mother Hoelun, and who later became the leader of a unit of one thousand. Many scholars assume that the adopted Kokochu was placed in charge of Mother Hoelun's people, but a case can be made that since Kokochu Teb Tengeri took over Mother Hoelun's people after her death, he was the Kokochu named as an administrator. While the issue of precise identity is perplexing, it is probably not particularly important. "Have you seen these?": Secret History, § 244. the Uighur khan: In the Secret History (§ 238), the Uighur leader is referred to as the Idu'ut, which means something like king, prince, or khan. II. The Mongol World War: 1211–1261 "By the arms of Zingis": Edward Gibbon, *Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire* (London, J. M. Dent, 1910), vol. 5, p. 76. 4. Spitting on the Golden Khan "The hooves of our Mongol horses": Quoted by a Sung representative in "Meng-Ta Peu-Lu Ausführliche Aufzeichnungen über die Mongolischen Tatan von Chao Hung, 1221," in Peter Olbricht and Elisabeth Pinks, *Meng-Ta Pei-Lu und Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh: Chinesische Gesandtenberichte über die frühen Mongolen 1221 und 1237* (Weisbaden: Otto Harrassowitz, 1980), p. 210. their capital city of Zhongdu: The same place had many names at different times. Under the Jurches, it was Zhongdu. When Khubilai Khan created his capital here it became known as Khanbalik (the khan's city) to Mongolians and other foreigners; the Chinese called it Dadu (or Ta-tu). Later, it was named Peking, and now Beijing. "reverently upon the ground": Peking Gazette, June 30, 1878, quoted in C. W. Campbell's *Travels in Mongolia: 1902* (reprint, London: Stationery Office, 2000), p. 74. the full commitment of every warrior: see Sechen Jagchid and Paul Hyer, *Mongolia's Culture and Society* (Boulder: Westview, 1979), p. 370. "Our empire is like the sea": "Meng-Ta Peu-Lu Ausführliche Aufzeichnungen über die Mongolischen Tatan von Chao Hung, 1221," in Peter Olbricht and Elisabeth Pinks, *Meng-Ta Pei Lu und Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh*, p. 61. Mongol military: Thomas J. Barfield, *The Perilous Frontier: Nomadic Empires and China, 221 B.C. to A.D. 1757* (Cambridge, Mass.: Blackwell, 1992). Mongol warriors could travel ten days: Marco Polo, *The Travels of Marco Polo*, trans. Teresa Waugh (New York: Facts on File, 1984), p. 57. needed no fires to cook: See "Meng-Ta Peu-Lu Ausführliche Aufzeichnungen über die Mongolischen Tatan von Chao Hung, 1221," in Peter Olbricht and Elisabeth Pinks, *Meng-Ta Pei-Lu und Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh*, p. 58. the central camp for

each unit: See “Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh Kurzer Bericht über die schwarzen Tatan von P’eng Ta-Ya und Sü T’ing, 1237,” in Peter Olbricht and Elisabeth Pinks, *Meng-Ta Pei-Lu und Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh: Chinesische Gesandtenberichte über die frühen Mongolen 1221 und 1237* (Weisbaden: Otto Harrassowitz, 1980), p. 187. communications became more important: Walther Heissig, *A Lost Civilization: The Mongols Rediscovered*, trans. D. J. S. Thompson (London: Thames & Hudson, 1966), p. 35. The Mongols referred to these grass-eating people: For more on the Mongol terminology for settled people, see Uradyn E. Bulag, *Nationality and Hybridity in Mongolia* (Oxford, U.K.: Clarendon Press, 1998), p. 213. “they come as though the sky were falling”: See “Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh Kurzer Bericht über die schwarzen Tatan von P’eng Ta-Ya und Sü T’ing, 1237,” in Peter Olbricht and Elisabeth Pinks, *Meng-Ta Pei-Lu und Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh*, p. 187. In 1219, the Year of the Hare: There is debate about whether some of these events occurred in 1207 or 1219, since both were the Year of the Hare. “red bull”: *Secret History*, § 240. Kashgar, a trading city: Regarding the events in Kashgar, the *Secret History* placed this invasion in the Year of the Ox, 1205, but almost all other sources show that it occurred in the Year of the Ox, 1217. Jebe’s army defeated the army of Guchlug: For more information on the Mongol campaign against Guchlug, see René Grousset, *The Empire of the Steppes: A History of Central Asia*, trans. Naomi Walford (New Brunswick, N. J.: Rutgers University Press, 1970), p. 234. “to be one of the mercies of the Lord”: Ata-Malik Juvaini, *Genghis Khan: The History of the World Conqueror*, trans. J. A. Boyle (Seattle: University of Washington Press, 1997), p. 67. “Jebe pursued Guchlug”: *Secret History*, § 237. “He had brought about complete peace and quiet”: Juvaini, *Genghis Khan*, p. 77. “this Emperor having nothing more to fear”: François Pétis de la Croix, *The History of Genghizcan the Great: First Emperor of the Ancient Moguls and Tartars* (London: Printed for J. Darby, etc. 1722), pp. 119–120. “I have the greatest desire to live in peace”: Quoted in René Grousset, *Conqueror of the World*, trans. Marian McKellar and Denis Sinor (New York: Orion Press, 1966), p. 209. “henceforth the abscess of evil”: Juvaini, *Genghis Khan*, pp. 79–81. “laid waste a whole world”: *Ibid.*, p. 80. “the whirlwind of anger”: *Ibid.*, p. 80. he uncovered “his head”: *Ibid.*, p. 80. 5. Sultan Versus Khan “War for the nomadic people”: Sechen Jagchid, *Essays in Mongolian Studies* (Provo: Brigham Young University Press, 1988), p. 12. the story of the tattooed messenger: François Pétis de la Croix, *The History of Genghizcan the Great: First Emperor of the Ancient Moguls and Tartars* (London: Printed for J. Darby, etc., 1722), p. 136 “Commanders, elders, and commonality”: Henry H. Howorth, *History of the Mongols*, pt. 1, *The Mongols Proper and the Kalmuks* (London: Longmans, Green, 1876), p. 81. “it is the will of God”: Robert P. Blake, and Richard N. Frye, “History of the Nation of the Archers (the Mongols) by Grigor of Akanc,” *Harvard Journal of Asiatic Studies* 12 (December 1949), p. 301. “effaced from off the earth”: Yaqut al-Hamawi quoted in Edward G. Browne, *The Literary History of Persia*, vol. 2 (Bethesda, Md.: Iranbooks, 1997), p. 431. “the greatest joy a man can know”: Michael Prawdin, *The Mongol Empire: Its Rise and Legacy*, trans. Eden Paul and Cedar Paul (London: George Allen & Unwin, 1940), p. 143. “Stories have been related to me”:

Quoted in Browne, *Literary History of Persia*, p. 430. All the Mongol prisoners: The murder of the Mongol warriors is related by Luc Kwanten, *Imperial Nomads: A History of Central Asia, 500–1500* (Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press, 1979), p. 131. nails into their heads: Stuart Legg, *The Barbarians of Asia: The Peoples of the Steppes from 1600 B.C.* (New York: Dorset, 1970), p. 274. Those cities that surrendered: For a fuller account of these campaigns, see David Morgan, *The Mongols* (Cambridge, Mass.: Blackwell, 1986), pp. 60–61. the numbers given by historians: For more on the supposedly high number of people killed, see Legg, *Barbarians of Asia*, p. 277. “if all my sons”: Paul Ratchnevsky, *Genghis Khan: His Life and Legacy*, trans. Thomas Nivison Haining (Oxford, U.K.: Blackwell, 1991), p. 140. “When you tell Jochi to speak”: Paul Kahn, *The Secret History of the Mongols: The Origins of Chinggis Khan* (Boston: Cheng & Tsui, 1998), p. 153. “She didn’t run away from home”: *Ibid.*, § 254. “from a single hot womb”: *Ibid.*, § 254. “game killed by mouth”: *Ibid.*, § 255. “Mother Earth is broad”: *Ibid.*, § 255. “laid the knee of courtesy”: Ata-Malik Juvaini, *Genghis Khan: The History of the World Conqueror*, trans. J. A. Boyle (Seattle: University of Washington Press, 1997), pp. 182–183. “because of——”: Rashid al-Din, *The Successors of Genghis Khan*, trans. John Andrew Boyle (New York: Columbia University Press, 1971), p. 98. “the vision should never stray”: Colonel Kh. Shagdar, “Ikh Khaadin surgaal gereeslel,” *Chingis Khaan Sydlal*, vol. 4 (2002), pp. 3–35; translated from the Mongolian. “People conquered on different sides”: *Ibid.*, p. 3–35. his men cordoned off: For a fuller description of the group hunting procedures, see “Hei-Ta Shih Lüeh Kurzer Bericht über die schwarzen Tatan von P’eng Ta-Ya und Sü T’ing, 1237,” in Peter Olbricht and Elisabeth Pinks, *Meng-Ta Pei-Lu und Hei-Ta Shih-Lüeh: Chinesische Gesandtenberichte über die frühen Mongolen 1221 und 1237* (Weisbaden: Otto Harrassowitz, 1980), p. 117